hunger. It set the “Millennium Development Goals: a compact among nations to end human poverty”. The declaration made by the Heads of States made it binding on them to “attack inadequate income, widespread hunger, gender inequality, environmental deterioration and lack of education, health care and clean water”. These also included actions on the part of the developed countries to reduce debt and increase aid, trade and technology transfer to poorer countries. Some of the targets outlined by the Millennium Development Goals were:

- Eradication of extreme poverty and hunger
- Achieving universal primary education
- Promotion of gender equality and empowerment of women
- Reduction of child mortality
- Improvement of maternal health
- Combating HIV/AIDS, malaria and other diseases
- Ensuring environmental sustainability
- Development of a global partnership

Therefore, there was a sea-change in the concept of development, so much so that the critical assessment of the post-War international economic order led to the formation of a critical alternative view of development. This view stated that the process of development should be

- need-oriented (material and non-material);
- endogenous (coming from within a society);
- self-reliant (in terms of human, natural and cultural resources);
- ecologically sound; and
- based on structural transformations (of economy, society and power relations).

This vision of development championed by the NGOs and the two-year preparatory process before the UN Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED) in Rio in June 1992, gave a chance to